

Note from the above table that upgrade options are not available for versions of Windows earlier than Windows 2000. These versions require you to install a full copy of Windows Vista. Also, for those of you currently using Windows 2000 Professional or Windows XP Professional x64, you are eligible for an upgrade copy to a corresponding or better edition of Windows Vista, but a clean install is required.

1.3 Hardware Requirements — Minimum And Optimal

Microsoft classifies computers capable of running Vista into two categories—you have the Vista Capable computer, which can run the OS but not with all the visual features, and then you have the Vista Premium Ready computer, which will be capable of running Vista in all its glory. A Vista Capable computer needs to have a processor running at least 800 MHz, 512 MB of RAM, and a DirectX 9 class graphics card. A Vista

Windows Vista System Requirements		
Hardware	Vista Capable	Vista Premium Ready
Processor	800 MHz	1 GHz
Memory	512 MB	1 GB
Graphics card	DirectX 9 capable	DirectX 9 capable with Vista driver support
Graphics card's memory	64 MB	128 MB for 1920 x 1200 and 512MB for 2560 x 1600
Hard drive capacity	20 GB	40 GB
Hard drive free space	15 GB	15 GB
Optical drive	DVD	DVD